

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Animals can sometimes be pests!



## Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in social contexts.

### Ask your partner:

- What animals do you not care to have in your home?
- What animals in your country do damage to food crops or homes?

## Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences, strange events or superstitions.
- I can use proper intonation of finished and unfinished ideas.
- I can use different tones to stress, contrast or emphasize information.





## Let's Explore!

I mean it does sound crazy ... **right\***?

\* When you use "*right*" at the end of a sentence, your voice goes up because you are both expecting an affirmative response and asking a question.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

NASA had to delay launching a space shuttle because of woodpeckers. Woodpeckers ... ? Like that little guy ... what's his name ... in the cartoon? That doesn't make any sense. You do agree ... I mean it does sound crazy ... right?

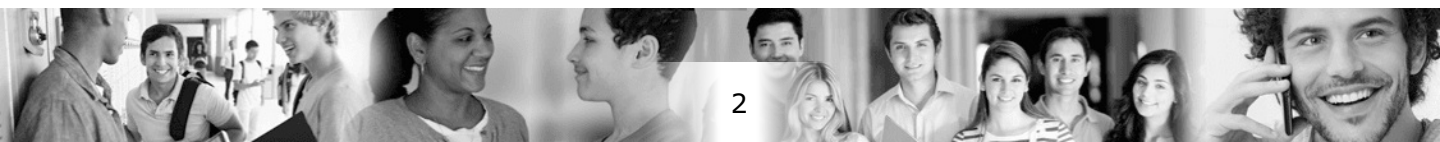
So, these woodpeckers ... yes, your garden variety woodpeckers ... punched hundreds of tiny holes in the insulation - the foam around the shuttle fuel tank - as it sat on the platform before the launch.

Of course, the mission had to be put off. Workers were hoisted up a staggering 25 stories on a crane to repair the damage. The birds, it seems, had flown the coop ... so to speak.

The wind did not cooperate. Consequently, they had to disconnect, then tow the tank, to a building ... in a totally different area. This set back the launch ... wait for it ... a couple of months.

This is the first time, but hopefully the last time, that woodpeckers have caused problems severe enough to set back a shuttle launch. Not that they would tell us anyway ... and why woodpeckers would peck into the thick orange foam left NASA officials baffled.

Worse ... they're not sure what to do to protect future shuttles. NASA workers have tried to scare the woodpeckers off with plastic owls on the launch pad and loud noises, all to no avail. Have a good idea? I'm sure NASA would love to hear from you!





## Let's Practice!

NASA has problems with woodpeckers?

*Instructions: Read the sentences below, circle the incorrect words and write the correct ones above them.*

- 1) Does NASA have problems with woodpeckers?
- 2) Woodpeckers punched dozens of rolls in the foam insulation.
- 3) The insulation is around the shuttle fuelling trunk .
- 4) Woodpeckers have because programs for the space shuttle program.
- 5) Why they would peck into the think range form left NASA officials baffled.



## Let's Practice!

What caused problems?

*Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the words given.*

### Word Bank

- |                |            |         |
|----------------|------------|---------|
| • first        | • set back | • NASA  |
| • hear         | • months   | • love  |
| • severe       | • protect  | • scare |
| • plastic owls | • what     |         |

- 1) This is the \_\_\_\_\_ time that woodpeckers have caused such \_\_\_\_\_ problems for the space shuttle program.
- 2) This \_\_\_\_\_ the launch ... wait for it ... a couple of \_\_\_\_\_
- 3) Worse ... they are not sure \_\_\_\_\_ to do to \_\_\_\_\_ future shuttles.
- 4) NASA workers have tried to \_\_\_\_\_ the woodpeckers off with \_\_\_\_\_ on the launch pad.
- 5) I'm sure \_\_\_\_\_ would \_\_\_\_\_ to \_\_\_\_\_ any good ideas!





## Extension Activity

Listen to a North American sitcom episode.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Listen to a portion of a North American sitcom episode for word stress.
- Listen again and write down some sentences.
- Underline stressed words and syllables.
- Practice saying the sentence with the actors on the show.
- Bring your sentences to class and read the lines with the correct stress.
- Hand a partner your lines and have them read them to you with the correct stress.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I listen to part of a North American sitcom.

☐ ☐

I write down sentences and underline the word and syllable stress.

☐ ☐

I practice saying the sentences with the actors on the sitcom.

☐ ☐

I read my sentences aloud to a partner with the correct stress.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- **to launch** (verb): set in motion  
e.g. NASA had to delay launching a space shuttle.
- **woodpecker** (noun): a bird that pecks into wood looking for insects to eat  
e.g. The woodpeckers put holes in the insulation.
- **to punch** (verb): to hit something hard  
e.g. Woodpeckers were able to punch holes into the insulation!
- **foam** (noun): a soft spongy material  
e.g. They put holes in the foam around the tank.
- **insulation** (noun): a material used to protect something  
e.g. There was foam insulation around the fuel tank.
- **fuel tank** (noun): a container to hold liquid fuel  
e.g. The insulation around the fuel tank had holes in it.
- **to set back** (verb): to reverse progress  
e.g. The holes set back the shuttle program for months!
- **crane** (noun): a tall machine for moving heavy objects  
e.g. Workers were sent aloft in a 25-story crane to make repairs.
- **to baffle** (verb): to bewilder; to perplex  
e.g. Why woodpeckers would peck into foam left NASA officials baffled.





## Learning Points

### Intonation of Finished and Unfinished Ideas

When you speak English, it is up to you to make sure that you are clear when you speak.

The listener shouldn't have to work hard to understand the communication.

So when you speak, your voice should **fully fall** at the end of a thought group or sentence. This tells the person listening that you are finished with the statement.

On the other hand, your voice should **partially fall** at the end of a thought group to show that you are NOT finished with the statement.

This gives the listener time to think about what you have said and makes them expect you to continue.

| Statement                                                                                                      | Comment                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Woodpeckers ... ? like that little guy ... what's his name ... in the cartoon?</i>                          | At every ellipsis, the speaker's voice partially falls, signaling that there is more to come. Note that even though the idea is complete at the end, because it is a question, the voice does not fully fall. |
| <i>The wind did not cooperate.</i>                                                                             | At the end of the sentence, the voice fully falls, showing it is finished.                                                                                                                                    |
| <i>Consequently, they had to disconnect, then tow the tank, to a building ... in a totally different area.</i> | At the ellipsis, the speaker's voice partially falls, signaling that there is more to come, then continues on to fully fall at the end of the sentence to signal that it is finished.                         |





## Learning Points

### Tonic, Contrastive, Emphatic and New Information Stress

There are various types of stress used when speaking English.

**Tonic stress** refers to the syllable in a word which receives the most stress in an intonation unit.

This is the first **time**

This is the first **time** / that **woodpeckers**

This is the first **time**, but hopefully the **last** time, that **woodpeckers** have caused problems severe enough to set back a shuttle **launch**.

When you want to point out the difference between one object and another, you use **contrastive stress**. It tends to be used with determiners such as 'this, that, these and those'.

For example:

Not **this** book, **that** one.

**To emphasize** a word, you can change the stress from the principal word to another content word. By choosing a word other than the one you normally stress, you put emphasis on the new one.

For example:

This is **not** the right way!

Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or "beat".

When you **stress new information**, you pronounce new information with more breath force, since it is more prominent.

